

A FEMALE CRUSOE.

The San Francisco journals contain an account of what they call a California Crusoe, an Indian woman who had for eighteen years lived alone on a dreary desert island, and was finally discovered and taken off by the crew of a vessel in search of her. Many years ago a small schooner was sent to the island of San Nicholas, in the Pacific, some seventy-five miles southeast of Santa Barbara, to bring away a number of Indians living there and settle them on the main land. Nineteen men, women and children had been got on board, when one of them, a mother, found that two of her offspring had been left behind. She immediately jumped overboard and swam to the island, where she sought in vain for her children. Having returned to the shore, she saw the schooner sailing away, and tried in vain to attract attention. The island was not visited again for sixteen years. Then an otter-hunter, named George Nidever, commanding a small vessel, landed there, and detected evidences of human habitation, but could not stay long enough to prosecute his quest; two years after he sailed there again and, roaming over the island, came upon the woman, who was not at all wild, and made no effort to escape. She was clad in a garment fashioned of the skin of a sea-fowl, and was occupied in skinning seal-blubber, which had formed the greater part of her diet. She was quite good-looking, seemed about fifty years old, and spoke a language nobody could understand. She died a few weeks after reaching Santa Barbara, while living in the house of Nidever, from the effects of a fall seriously injuring her spine.
